

Diploma in

PHOTOSHOP



SUMMARY NOTES

Advanced Layers & Masking
Lessons 11 & 12

THIS LESSON LOOKS AT HOW LAYER BLEND MODES WORK SO THAT WE CAN OVERLAY TEXTURES AND OTHER IMAGES ON TOP OF YOUR WORK TO CREATE SOME STRIKING ARTISTIC EFFECTS. WE WILL ALSO DISCUSS LAYER MASKS SO THAT WE CAN WORK IN A COMPLETELY NON-DESTRUCTIVE WAY WHEN MAKING ADJUSTMENTS AND SELECTIONS.

2.01	What Are Layers
2.02	Layers Types
2.03	Masking
2.04	Blend Modes
2.05	Textures
2.06	Dodge & Burn

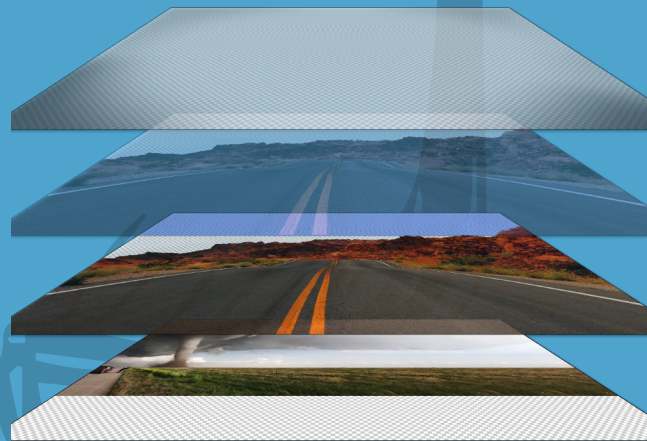
ADVANCED LAYERS&MASKING

WHAT ARE LAYERS?

“Layers are at the very core of image editing in Photoshop. We can think of layers in Photoshop as stackable elements, each of which holds a part of your image and they’re displayed in descending order.”

Photoshop layers are like sheets of stacked glass. You can see through transparent areas of a layer to the layers below. Transparency is represented by a chequered board pattern. A fully transparent area is missing colour in each square pixel. You can also change the opacity of a layer to make content partially transparent. These pixels are filled with colour but have a low value of transparency. Layers are non-destructive and completely reversible. They allow for safer and more professional editing.

Layers are at the very core of image editing in Photoshop. We can think of layers in Photoshop as stackable elements, each of which holds a part of your image and they’re displayed in descending order. Photoshop first introduced layers in 1994, and they have gotten incredibly complex since them! But the introduction of layers revolutionised photography. We can have up to 8,000 layers in an individual PSD.



Layers Tab

This refers to the overall lightness or darkness. We will change entire image pixels

Opacity

This will allow you to lower the visibility level of the layer

Filter

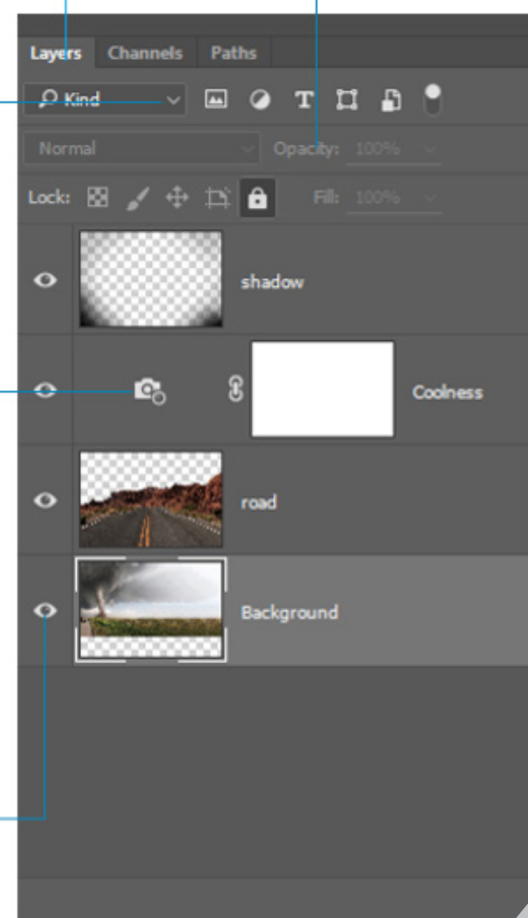
This will allow use to quickly find layers in bigger projects

Adjustment Layer

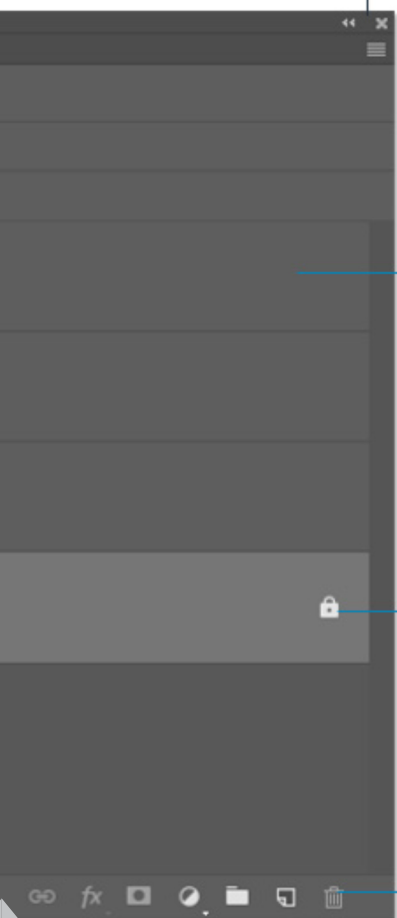
An adjustment layer is a non-destructive Adjustment. It comes

Toggle

This toggle will allow you to turn of the visibility off or on



over the
layer selected



Remove/Compact

This will allow you to remove or hide the layers panel. If you remove the layers panel, you can open it back up using the Window menu

New Layer

Another layer, this can be blank or can be filled as another image

Background

Most images, when open in Photoshop, will default with a locked background layer.

Layer Options

Here you can delete a layer, create a new layer, create a folder, create an adjustment layer, add a mask, add layer effects or link multiple layers

LAYER TYPES

Pixel Layer

The Pixel Layers are at the heart of image editing. A Pixel Layer is basically every image in you take and/or import into Photoshop. Blank Pixel Layers are transparent, meaning if we have a layer below we can see the pixels (the image). Using tools such as Brush and Burn alters the pixels of an image. Using Destructive Adjustments Alters the Pixels of your image

Adjustment Layer

An adjustment layer applies colour and tonal adjustments to your image without permanently changing pixel values, therefore they are considered non-destructive. The adjustments are stored in the adjustment layer and apply to all the layers below it. There are many advantages to using adjustment layers. As they are non-destructive, you can try different settings and re-edit the adjustment layer at any time. You can also reduce the effect of the adjustment by lowering the opacity of the layer or delete the adjustment entirely. Because adjustment layers contain adjustment data rather than pixels, they increase file size far less than standard pixel layers.

Text Layer

A text layer works just like a word document. You can change the type of font, the size and the colour. Each use of the text tool will create a new text layer to be edited and moved on the document stage. The text layer can be rasterised into pixels for further editing.

Shape Layer

A Shape layer is a vector based design within the largely raster based Photoshop. A shape layer is not pixel based but a vector meaning it can scale up and down without any loss to the image. This is like Adobe Illustrator, a vector based editor. The shape layer can be added and subtracted from using the various other shape layer types. The shape layers consist of a rectangle, rounded rectangle, ellipse, polygon and custom shape options based on icons. You can create your own custom shapes and save them in Photoshop for further use.



MASKING

Masking can be explained as hiding certain pixels to let the image below be seen. Masks are applied to a layer and can be used on every type of layer. Layer masks use values of grey to assign levels of transparency to specific portions of a layer or group of layers.

To select a layer mask you have two options:

1. From the Menu: Layer > Layer Mask > Reveal all or Hide All
2. From the Layers Panel using the Layer Mask icon

Use the brush tool when you have the layer mask selected. When a mask is applied to an image it appears as a separate white box next to the image. By default this box is filled with White colour. This is due to the colour values of white showing or revealing the coloured pixels. Due to this Black colour will hide or mask the coloured pixels of your image. Different tones of Grey can be used to give the appearance of opacity being applied, however opacity is separate and can still be applied.

A good way to remember the values of masking is to say:

“Black to Conceal, White to Reveal”

White will show your layer while black will hide or mask the layer.

Adjustment Layer masks

All layers can have a layer mask applied but the adjustment layer is defaulted with a layer mask.

This is to provide the user the opportunity to mask certain parts of the image, in turn only revealing/concealing the adjustment at that part. This allows for more detailed adjustments.

Tip: It is also noted that gradients will give you a faded style as the colours go from Black to white. Use the gradient tool to instead of a brush tool.



BLEND MODES

Normal

Edits or paints each pixel to make it the result colour. This is the default mode. (Normal mode is called Threshold when you're working with a bitmapped or indexed-colour image.)

Dissolve

Edits or paints each pixel to make it the result colour. However, the result colour is a random replacement of the pixels with the base colour or the blend colour, depending on the opacity at any pixel location.

Darken

Looks at the colour information in each channel and selects the base or blend colour—whichever is darker—as the result colour. Pixels lighter than the blend colour are replaced, and pixels darker than the blend colour do not change.

Multiply

Looks at the colour information in each channel and multiplies the base colour by the blend colour. The result colour is always a darker colour. Multiplying any colour with black produces black. Multiplying any colour with white leaves the colour unchanged. When you're painting with a colour other than black or white, successive strokes with a painting tool produce progressively darker colours. The effect is similar to drawing on the image with multiple marking pens.

Colour Burn

Looks at the colour information in each channel and darkens the base colour to reflect the blend colour by increasing the contrast between the two. Blending with white produces no change.

Linear Burn

Looks at the colour information in each channel and darkens the base colour to reflect the blend colour by decreasing the brightness. Blending with white produces no change.

Blend colour to create the result colour.

Darker Colour

Compares the total of all channel values for the blend and base colour and displays the lower value colour. Darker Colour does not produce a third colour, which can result from the Darken blend, because it chooses the lowest channel values from both the base and the blend colour to create the result colour.

Lighten

Looks at the colour information in each channel and selects the base or blend colour—whichever is lighter—as the result colour. Pixels darker than the blend colour are replaced, and pixels lighter than the blend colour do not change.

Screen

Looks at each channel's colour information and multiplies the inverse of the blend and base colours. The result colour is always a lighter colour. Screening with black leaves the colour unchanged. Screening with white produces white. The effect is similar to projecting multiple photographic slides on top of each other.

Colour Dodge

Looks at the colour information in each channel and brightens the base colour to reflect the blend colour by decreasing contrast between the two. Blending with black produces no change.

Linear Dodge (Add)

Looks at the colour information in each channel and brightens the base colour to reflect the blend colour by increasing the brightness. Blending with black produces no change.

Lighter Colour

Compares the total of all channel values for the blend and base colour and displays the higher value colour. Lighter Colour does not produce a third colour, which can result from the Lighten blend, because it chooses the highest channel values from both the base and blend colour to create the result colour.

Overlay

Multiplies or screens the colours, depending on the base colour. Patterns or colours overlay the existing pixels while preserving the highlights and shadows of the base colour. The base colour is not replaced, but mixed with the blend colour to reflect the lightness or darkness of the original colour.

Soft Light

Darkens or lightens the colours, depending on the blend colour. The effect is similar to shining a diffused spotlight on the image. If the blend colour (light source) is lighter than 50% gray, the image is lightened as if it were dodged. If the blend colour is darker than 50% gray, the image is darkened as if it were burned in. Painting with pure black or white produces a distinctly darker or lighter area, but does not result in pure black or white.

Hard Light

Multiplies or screens the colours, depending on the blend colour. The effect is similar to shining a harsh spotlight on the image. If the blend colour (light source) is lighter than 50% gray, the image is lightened, as if it were screened. This is useful for adding highlights to an image. If the blend colour is darker than 50% gray, the image is darkened, as if it were multiplied. This is useful for adding shadows to an image. Painting with pure black or white results in pure black or white.

Vivid Light

Burns or dodges the colours by increasing or decreasing the contrast, depending on the blend colour. If the blend colour (light source) is lighter than 50% gray, the image is lightened by decreasing the contrast. If the blend colour is darker than 50% gray, the image is darkened by increasing the contrast.

Linear Light

Burns or dodges the colours by decreasing or increasing the brightness, depending on the blend colour. If the blend colour (light source) is lighter than 50% gray, the image is lightened by increasing the brightness. If the blend colour is darker than 50% gray, the image is darkened by decreasing the brightness.

Pin Light

Replaces the colours, depending on the blend colour. If the blend colour (light source) is lighter than 50% gray, pixels darker than the blend colour are replaced, and pixels lighter than the blend colour do not change. If the blend colour is darker than 50% gray, pixels lighter than the blend colour are replaced, and pixels darker than the blend colour do not change. This is useful for adding special effects to an image.

Hard Mix

Adds the red, green and blue channel values of the blend colour to the RGB values of the base colour. If the resulting sum for a channel is 255 or greater, it receives a value of 255; if less than 255, a value of 0. Therefore, all blended pixels have red, green, and blue channel values of either 0 or 255. This changes all pixels to primary additive colours (red, green, or blue), white, or black.

Difference

Looks at the colour information in each channel and subtracts either the blend colour from the base colour or the base colour from the blend colour, depending on which has the greater brightness value. Blending with white inverts the base colour values; blending with black produces no change.

Exclusion

Creates an effect similar to but lower in contrast than the Difference mode. Blending with white inverts the base colour values. Blending with black produces no change.

Subtract

Looks at the colour information in each channel and subtracts the blend colour from the base colour. In 8- and 16-bit images, any resulting negative values are clipped to zero. Divide Looks at the colour information in each channel and divides the blend colour from the base colour.

Hue

Creates a result colour with the luminance and saturation of the base colour and the hue of the blend colour.

Saturation

Creates a result colour with the luminance and hue of the base colour and the saturation of the blend colour. Painting with this mode in an area with no (0) saturation (gray) causes no change.

Colour

Creates a result colour with the luminance of the base colour and the hue and saturation of the blend colour. This preserves the gray levels in the image and is useful for colouring monochrome images and for tinting colour images.

Luminosity

Creates a result colour with the hue and saturation of the base colour and the luminance of the blend colour. This mode creates the inverse effect of Colour mode.





TEXTURES

Textures are amazing can have many uses in Photoshop. Combined with blend modes, selections and masking it is possible to create a range of effects. From changing the background of an image to overlaying with blend modes, each texture can provide a different feel, look and output to your images.

Textures as a background

Textures can easily add a dynamic and quick change to any image. Simply removing the background from one image and replacing it can transform you image completely. Use your selection tools to highlight the image you wish to keep. Select and mask your selection to your liking. When refined, it is now easy to use our textures as different layers. Now duplicate the selection to separate it from the background. This is like image composites in many ways. Don't forget to add shadows and highlights to make the image look realistic. I added shadow by duplication the selection of the man and applying a colour overlay of black. I then used a blur filter and moved the shadow into place. Reduce opacity as you see fit.



Textures as Text

The simplest way to use textures is as text. This is done by creating a clipping mask of your texture above a text layer. This will mask the texture inside your chosen font.

TIGER

Textures as an Overlay

Textures can provide great effects to your images when combined with Photoshop's sophisticated Blend Textures are amazing and can have many uses in Photoshop. Combined with blend modes, selections and masking it is possible to create a range of effects. From changing the background of an image to overlaying with blend modes, each texture can provide a different feel, look and output to your images.



DODGE & BURN

Dodge and Burn are tools located on the tool bar. The shortcut for both tools, and the Sponge tool, is the letter O. the process of dodge and burn is to darken (burn) or lighten (Dodge) parts of an image. These tools are a process of destructive editing.

Non-Destructive Dodge & Burn

Like most processes in Photoshop they come with a destructive and non-destructive option. To use the technique of non-destructive Dodge and Burn you must follow certain steps.

Create a new layer

- Menu: Layer > New Layer
- Ctrl + Shift + N/Cmd + Shift + N
- Alt and the new layer icon form the layer panel.

Fill in the new layer box

- Colour =optional for own use.
- Mode = Overlay
- Turn on fill with overlay-neutral (50% grey)

This will produce a new layer filled with a grey tone. This grey tone as a blend mode overlay is the perfect opacity. This means depending on what tones you use it is possible to darken or lighten the image non-destructively.

- The Dodge tool will lighten the grey tone.
- The Burn tool will darken the grey tone.

Tip: It is also possible to use the brush tool and different shades of grey to have the same outcome.





THANK YOU